

Online Friends vs. Real Friends



BIG IDEA People in a game chat may not be who they say. I keep private things private, and I never keep a “yucky secret.” I tell a grown-up.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

1 HOOK 2 MIN *60-second script* Hold up the Maya card.

“Maya loves her class friends. She sees them every day. They are her **real-life friends**. Some people in a game chat are **online friends**. Maybe they’re nice. But online we cannot see who is really there. They might not be a kid. We **can’t be sure**. So Hackle has a rule: **“With people I only know online, I keep private things private, and I tell a grown-up if something feels strange.”** A surprise is a happy party for your mom, and soon everybody knows. A **secret that makes your tummy feel funny**, one someone says you can never tell your grown-ups, we tell. Always.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN *Surprise or Tell?*

1 (2 min) Surprise or Tell? Show each Surprise-or-Secret card. Happy surprise: party-popper jump, “Surprise!” “Don’t tell your grown-ups,” or a request for private things or pictures: hand on heart, reach out, “Tell!”

2 (4 min) Game-chat cards. Read each pretend message calmly. Class: Pause Palm, “I’ll tell my grown-up!” The sixth (“Great job on that level!”) is kind, and a grown-up should still know who we play with. No menacing voice; nobody plays the stranger.

3 (1 min) Family-approved friends. We only play with people our grown-ups know and approve.

4 (1 min) Never your fault. If someone says something yucky in a chat, telling is exactly right.

FUN BOOST **Surprise Jump or Tell Wave (30 seconds).** Read a card; everyone does the move.

LEVEL-UP **Teach a Friend.** Explain “surprise vs. yucky secret” to a stuffed animal.

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: 6 game-chat cards (pretend messages from “Player123”), 8 Surprise-or-Secret cards, floor spots “Happy Surprise” and “Tell a Grown-Up.”

- ☐ Lay out the two floor spots.
- ☐ Sort the 8 cards: four surprises, four secrets.
- ☐ Order the 6 chat cards; the sixth is a kind message.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

1 “Can we always tell who is in a game chat?” (No.)

2 “Surprise or secret: what is the difference?” (A surprise is happy and shared soon. A secret to hide from grown-ups, we tell.)

3 “Whose fault is it if someone says something yucky?” (Never mine.)

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN **“Online, I can’t always tell who is who. I keep private things private. I never keep a yucky secret. I tell a grown-up.”**

Hand signal: **Pause** (palm). **Check** how my tummy feels. **Tell** (hand on heart, reach out).

EXIT TICKET Draw a **heart** by the picture you would **tell** a grown-up about (the chat bubble that says “Don’t tell your parents”).

DIFFERENTIATE Use only the surprise-or-secret cards. “Secret” can mean different things in other languages: use pictures. Never criticize a family’s rules.

FAMILY CARD Ask: “Is there anything in your games that you want to show me?” Thank your child for telling you.

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me.”
- “I believe you. It is not your fault.”
- “I will get help from someone whose job is to keep kids safe.”

- **Do not say:** “I promise I won’t tell anyone.”
- “Why didn’t you tell me sooner?” or “Are you sure?”
- Any leading question (“Did he touch you?”).

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.